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FREQUENTLY ASKED QUESTIONS

Pharmacy Prior Authorization Criteria

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Ustekinumab

Indications for Prior Authorization

Stelara SC (ustekinumab), Wezlana SC (ustekinumab-auub)

- **For diagnosis of Plaque Psoriasis (PsO)**
Indicated for the treatment of patients 6 years or older with moderate to severe plaque psoriasis who are candidates for phototherapy or systemic therapy.
- **For diagnosis of Psoriatic Arthritis (PsA)**
Indicated for the treatment of patients 6 years or older with active psoriatic arthritis.
- **For diagnosis of Crohn's Disease (CD)**
Indicated for the treatment of adult patients with moderately to severely active Crohn's disease.
- **For diagnosis of Ulcerative Colitis (UC)**
Indicated for the treatment of adult patients with moderately to severely active ulcerative colitis.

Stelara IV (ustekinumab), Wezlana IV (ustekinumab-auub)

- **For diagnosis of Crohn's Disease (CD)**
Indicated for the treatment of adult patients with moderately to severely active Crohn's disease.
- **For diagnosis of Ulcerative Colitis (UC)**
Indicated for the treatment of adult patients with moderately to severely active ulcerative colitis.

Criteria

Stelara SC & Wezlana SC 45 mg/0.5 mL

Prior Authorization (Initial Authorization)

Length of Approval: 6 Month(s)

For diagnosis of Plaque Psoriasis

- *Diagnosis of moderate to severe plaque psoriasis*
AND
- *One of the following [2]:*
 - Greater than or equal to 3% body surface area involvement
 - Severe scalp psoriasis
 - Palmoplantar (i.e., palms, soles), facial, or genital involvement**AND**
- *Patient is 6 years of age or older*
AND
- *Minimum duration of a 4-week trial and failure, contraindication, or intolerance to one of the following topical therapies [3]:*
 - corticosteroids (e.g., betamethasone, clobetasol)
 - vitamin D analogs (e.g., calcitriol, calcipotriene)
 - tazarotene

- calcineurin inhibitors (e.g., tacrolimus, pimecrolimus)

AND

- Prescribed by or in consultation with a dermatologist

Stelara SC & Wezlana SC 90 mg/1 mL

Prior Authorization (Initial Authorization)

Length of Approval: 6 Month(s)

For diagnosis of Plaque Psoriasis

- *Diagnosis of moderate to severe plaque psoriasis*

AND

- *One of the following [2]:*
 - Greater than or equal to 3% body surface area involvement
 - Severe scalp psoriasis
 - Palmoplantar (i.e., palms, soles), facial, or genital involvement

AND

- *Patient's weight is greater than 100 kg (220 lbs)*

AND

- *Patient is 6 years of age or older*

AND

- *Minimum duration of a 4-week trial and failure, contraindication, or intolerance to one of the following topical therapies [3]:*
 - corticosteroids (e.g., betamethasone, clobetasol)
 - vitamin D analogs (e.g., calcitriol, calcipotriene)
 - tazarotene
 - calcineurin inhibitors (e.g., tacrolimus, pimecrolimus)

AND

- *Prescribed by or in consultation with a dermatologist*

Stelara SC, Wezlana SC

Prior Authorization (Reauthorization)

Length of Approval: 12 Month(s)

For diagnosis of Plaque Psoriasis

- *Patient demonstrates positive clinical response to therapy as evidenced by ONE of the following [1-3]:*
 - Reduction in the body surface area (BSA) involvement from baseline
 - Improvement in symptoms (e.g., pruritus, inflammation) from baseline

Stelara SC & Wezlana SC 45 mg/0.5 mL

Prior Authorization (Initial Authorization)

Length of Approval: 6 Month(s)

For diagnosis of Psoriatic arthritis

- *Diagnosis of active psoriatic arthritis*

AND

- *One of the following [4]:*
 - Actively inflamed joints
 - Dactylitis
 - Enthesitis
 - Axial disease
 - Active skin and/or nail involvement

AND

- *Patient is 6 years of age or older*

AND

- *Prescribed by or in consultation with one of the following:*
 - Dermatologist
 - Rheumatologist

Stelara SC & Wezlana SC 90 mg/1 mL

Prior Authorization (Initial Authorization)

Length of Approval: 6 Month(s)

For diagnosis of Psoriatic arthritis

- *Diagnosis of active psoriatic arthritis*
AND
- *One of the following [4]:*
 - Actively inflamed joints
 - Dactylitis
 - Enthesitis
 - Axial disease
 - Active skin and/or nail involvement**AND**
- *Diagnosis of co-existent moderate to severe psoriasis [1, 4]*
AND
- *Patient's weight is greater than 100 kg (220 lbs)*
AND
- *Patient is 6 years of age or older*
AND
- *Prescribed by or in consultation with one of the following:*
 - Dermatologist
 - Rheumatologist

Stelara SC, Wezlana SC

Prior Authorization (Reauthorization)

Length of Approval: 12 Month(s)

For diagnosis of Psoriatic arthritis

- *Patient demonstrates positive clinical response to therapy as evidenced by at least one of the following [1, 4]:*
 - Reduction in the total active (swollen and tender) joint count from baseline
 - Improvement in symptoms (e.g., pain, stiffness, pruritus, inflammation) from baseline
 - Reduction in the body surface area (BSA) involvement from baseline

Stelara IV, Wezlana IV

Prior Authorization

Length of Approval: 1 Time(s)

For diagnosis of Crohn's Disease

- *Diagnosis of moderately to severely active Crohn's disease*
AND
- *One of the following [5, 6]:*
 - Frequent diarrhea and abdominal pain
 - At least 10% weight loss
 - Complications such as obstruction, fever, abdominal mass
 - Abnormal lab values (e.g., C-reactive protein [CRP])
 - CD Activity Index (CDAI) greater than 220**AND**
- *Trial and failure, contraindication, or intolerance to ONE of the following conventional therapies [5, 6]:*
 - 6-mercaptopurine
 - azathioprine
 - corticosteroids (e.g., prednisone)
 - methotrexate**AND**
- *Medication is to be administered as an intravenous induction dose*
AND
- *Medication induction dosing is in accordance with the United States Food and Drug Administration approved labeled dosing for Crohn's disease:*
 - 260 mg for patients weighing 55 kg or less
 - 390 mg for patients weighing more than 55 kg to 85 kg
 - 520 mg for patients weighing more than 85 kg

AND

- *Prescribed by or in consultation with a gastroenterologist*

Stelara SC, Wezlana SC

Prior Authorization (Initial Authorization)

Length of Approval: 6 Month(s)

For diagnosis of Crohn's Disease

- *Diagnosis of moderately to severely active Crohn's disease*
AND
- *Will be used as a maintenance dose following the intravenous induction dose*
AND
- *Prescribed by or in consultation with a gastroenterologist*

Stelara IV, Wezlana IV

Prior Authorization

Length of Approval: 1 Time(s)

For diagnosis of Ulcerative Colitis

- *Diagnosis of moderately to severely active ulcerative colitis*
AND
- *One of the following [7, 8]:*
 - Greater than 6 stools per day
 - Frequent blood in the stools
 - Frequent urgency
 - Presence of ulcers
 - Abnormal lab values (e.g., hemoglobin, ESR, CRP)
 - Dependent on, or refractory to, corticosteroids**AND**
- *Trial and failure, contraindication, or intolerance to ONE of the following conventional therapies [7, 8]:*
 - Corticosteroid (e.g., prednisone)
 - 6-mercaptopurine
 - Azathioprine
 - Aminosalicylates (e.g., mesalamine, olsalazine, sulfasalazine)**AND**
- *Medication is to be administered as an intravenous induction dose*
AND
- *Medication induction dosing is in accordance with the United States Food and Drug Administration approved labeled dosing for ulcerative colitis:*
 - 260 mg for patients weighing 55 kg or less
 - 390 mg for patients weighing more than 55 kg to 85 kg
 - 520 mg for patients weighing more than 85 kg**AND**
- *Prescribed by or in consultation with a gastroenterologist*

Stelara SC, Wezlana SC

Prior Authorization (Initial Authorization)

Length of Approval: 6 Month(s)

For diagnosis of Ulcerative Colitis

- *Diagnosis of moderately to severely active ulcerative colitis*
AND
- *Will be used as a maintenance dose following the intravenous induction dose*
AND
- *Prescribed by or in consultation with a gastroenterologist*

Stelara SC, Wezlana SC

Prior Authorization (Reauthorization)

Length of Approval: 12 Month(s)

For diagnosis of Crohn's Disease and Ulcerative Colitis

- *Patient demonstrates positive clinical response to therapy as evidenced by at least one of the following [1, 5-8]:*
 - Improvement in intestinal inflammation (e.g., mucosal healing, improvement of lab values [platelet counts, erythrocyte sedimentation rate, C-reactive protein level]) from baseline
 - Reversal of high fecal output state

-
- Guideline ID
GL-162526

-
- Formulary
Premium

-
- Effective date
Jan 1, 2025

-
- P&T approval date
Feb 16, 2010

P & T Revisions

2024-12-27, 2024-12-24, 2024-09-15, 2024-08-08, 2023-11-30, 2023-09-02, 2022-12-07, 2022-10-24, 2022-10-03, 2022-10-03, 2022-09-09, 2021-09-03, 2021-05-26, 2021-05-25, 2021-05-12, 2020-10-20, 2020-09-18, 2019-10-30, 2019-09-26

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4. Singh JA, Guyatt G, Ogdie A, et al. 2018 American College of Rheumatology/National Psoriasis Foundation guideline for the treatment of psoriatic arthritis. Arthritis Rheumatol. 2019;71(1):5-32.
5. Lichtenstein GR, Loftus EV, Isaacs KL, et al. ACG clinical guideline: management of Crohn's disease in adults. Am J Gastroenterol. 2018;113:481-517.
6. Feuerstein JD, Ho EY, Shmidt E, et al. AGA Clinical Practice Guidelines on the Medical Management of Moderate to Severe Luminal and Perianal Fistulizing Crohn's Disease. Gastroenterology. 2021;160(7):2496-2508.
7. Rubin DT, Ananthakrishnan AN, Siegel CA, et al. ACG clinical guideline: ulcerative colitis in adults. Am J Gastroenterol. 2019;114:384-413.
8. Feuerstein JD, Isaacs KL, Schneider Y, et al. AGA clinical practice guidelines on the management of moderate to severe ulcerative colitis. Gastroenterol. 2020;158:1450-1461.
9. Wezlana prescribing information. Amgen, Inc. Thousand Oaks, CA. October 2023.

Revision History

- **2024-12-27:** Replaced reference to 'stelara' with 'medication' where it also applies to Wezlana.
- **2024-12-24:** Addition of Wezlana to existing criteria
- **2024-09-15:** Removed anthralin and coal tar as topical step options for PsO. Annual review - Updated ulcerative colitis conventional step verbiage to align with other agents ("Trial and failure, contraindication, or intolerance to one of the following conventional therapies") - no change to clinical intent.
- **2024-08-08:** Removal of the QL loading dose notes; no criteria changes
- **2023-11-30:** Program update to standard reauthorization language. No changes to clinical intent.
- **2023-09-02:** Annual review - no criteria changes
- **2022-12-07:** Further clinical detail and criteria added; removal of conventional step from SC UC and CD criteria.
- **2022-10-24:** Further clinical detail and criteria added

- **2022-10-03:** Annual review - added age criterion for psoriasis; updated psoriatic arthritis indication and criteria to include patients 6 years or older
 - **2022-10-03:** Annual review - added age criterion for psoriasis; updated psoriatic arthritis indication and criteria to include patients 6 years or older
 - **2022-09-09:** Annual review - added age criterion for psoriasis; updated psoriatic arthritis indication and criteria to include patients 6 years or older
 - **2021-09-03:** Annual review
 - **2021-05-26:** Addition of EHB formulary to guideline, no changes to criteria
 - **2021-05-25:** Addition of EHB formulary to guideline, no changes to criteria
 - **2021-05-12:** Background update
 - **2020-10-20:** Updated TNF inhibitor examples to remove brand names for infliximab
 - **2020-09-18:** Annual review: Updated psoriasis indication to reflect the recent approval for patients 6 years of age and older; Addition of objective measures to the psoriasis reauthorization criteria; addition of notes for loading dose QL override; reference updates
 - **2019-10-30:** Updated Crohn's disease indication based on updated PI; details regarding specific patient populations were moved to clinical studies section of the PI. Per call with Janssen Pharmaceuticals on 10/21/19, the FDA requested that information be moved to the clinical studies section.
 - **2019-09-26:** Annual Review; removed the restriction prohibiting use in combination with a biologic DMARD; for Stelara 90 mg/1 mL, for the psoriatic arthritis indication, added a requirement for a diagnosis of co-existent moderate to severe psoriasis.
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